

Alex Rivera

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Dear Hiring Team,

Introduction

I build software that shows its working, so the people using it can trust what it decides. I came to this from hospitality, where I ran a busy café's ordering system, taught myself Python to automate the stock count, and then went back to study computer science. I finished my degree in 2020 and have spent four years as a software engineer, the last two at Humongous Insurance in Auckland, shipping language model features in production.

I am applying for the Software Engineer, Platform role at Woodgrove Bank. Shared services like identity, payments and notifications are the kind of work I want to do more of, and Woodgrove being a New Zealand-owned bank serving 300,000 customers makes that concrete for me.

Why I Am a Good Fit

The role asks for three or more years on platform or backend services, and I have four, most recently designing typed REST APIs in Node.js and PostgreSQL for a claims portal and two partner integrations. It also asks for hands-on work with a major cloud, which is what I did when I moved four Node.js services to AWS Lambda and set up the GitHub Actions deployments that ship them. Reliability is part of the job too, and I have built the safety net for it before: I added Vitest and Playwright tests to a React and Next.js codebase that had none, so regressions were caught before customers saw them. My working languages are TypeScript, Node.js and Python rather than C# or Java, so .NET would be new to me, but I taught myself Python to fix a stock count once and I am happy to do that again.

Additional Information

I currently hold a valid open work visa valid until June 2028. I am available to start work after serving my 2-week notice period.

Kind regards,

Alex Rivera